CHAPTER TWENTY-FIVE

# Gaza, Hamas, and the "New" Antisemitism

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The third war over Gaza between Israel and Hamas brough in its wake an explosion of global Jews-hatred arguably more intense than any previous wave of hositlity since 1945. One of the most striking characteristics of this current wave has been the primary role of Islamist and Muslim demonstrators supported by pro-Palestine groups on the Left. Another feature is that the indignation against Israel has appeared stronger in the West than in leading Arab nations such as Egypt, Saudi Arabia, or the Gulf States, except for Qatar. Indeed, it seemed at times as if these countries (as well as the Palestinian Authority) shared a common interest with Israel in seeing the defeat of Hamas and of Islamic radicalism more generally. Yet, despite the shocking religious bigotry, homophobia, misogyny, the violent persecution of Christians in the Middle East, and the chilling Judeophobia, Islamists have harnered considerable sympathy in the West as authentic representatives of the Palestinian cause. Yet Israel—despite being the region's only free, tolerant, and open society—has been continually vilified by much of the mainstream Western media and by large sectors of publi opinion. While Israel is regularly denounced for a purely fictional "genocide," the lethal character of Hamas's Jew-hatered has been as much ignored as the equally toxic propaganda promoted by Iran.

Islamists have never made any secret of the centrality for them of the religious dimension of the Muslim-Jewish conflict—something still poorly understood or dismissed in the West. this is clearly spelled out in the radically antisemitic Hamas Covenant of 1988 which constitutes the ideological basis for its continuing *jihad* to annihilate Israel. The Covenant draws on a *hadith* attributed to Mohammed himself in which he purportedly declares:

> The Day of Judgement will not come until Muslims fight the Jews, when the Jew will hide behind stones and trees. The stones and trees

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